



Oceania

Oceania is the collective name for Australia, New Zealand, and the island groups in the Pacific Ocean, including Melanesia, Micronesia, and Polynesia. Australia dominates the region in size, population, and economic strength.

PACIFIC ISLANDS

There are more than 20,000 islands in the Pacific Ocean. These palm-covered paradises are either volcanic or part of natural reefs. While they may look similar, they are quite diverse in human culture.



ISLAND PARADISE
The Fijian archipelago (group of islands) is made up of more than 330 beautiful islands.

ABORIGINAL CULTURE

Aboriginal people have been living in Australia for more than 50,000 years. They have a tribal culture of storytelling and art, and a strong spiritual belief tying them to the land. Many still live in the Australian outback, where rocks feature their paintings.



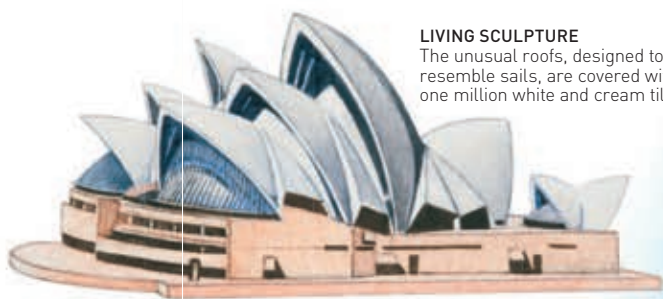
ROCK ART
Some of the oldest Aboriginal paintings are more than 20,000 years old.



ULURU
Particularly sacred to the Anangu Aboriginal people, this massive red monolith dominates the surrounding landscape.

SYDNEY OPERA HOUSE

The Sydney Opera House is a performing arts centre designed by Danish architect Jorn Utzon in 1957. It opened in 1973, and today is visited by more than seven million people every year.



LIVING SCULPTURE
The unusual roofs, designed to resemble sails, are covered with one million white and cream tiles.

SURFING

Australia is a first-class surfing destination, famous for both the quality and the variety of its waves. The coastline has plenty of beach, reef, and point breaks to challenge the experienced surfer, and easy rolling swells for beginners.



SURF CULTURE
With its world-renowned beaches, surfing and beach culture is a popular part of Australian life.

